

## THE PRICE OF CARELESSNESS.

Tragic Death of Little Paul Pratt.

DROWNS BEFORE HIS MOTHER

Falls from Sidewalk and River Carries Him to Death.

Picture a little six-year-old happy, care free, enjoying every minute of life, blowing his little whistle, running along after his mother, just as happy as God intends these little fellows to be. And five minutes later picture the little fellow dead. Think of his little body drawn tense and rigid with terror; think of his little body dragged under the water by the treacherous currents; think of his last despairing appeal to his helpless mother and his pitiful, helpless efforts to save himself.

Such a death is awful. It is a tragedy. Mrs. O. F. Platt, mother of the drowned boy, Paul, and her companion, Mrs. Catherine Lund, were on their way home from this city to Canemah Saturday afternoon. The boy was walking along behind them, blowing a whistle which his mother had bought him, and the ladies hearing his constant tooting never for a moment thought of danger to the lad.

And then there was a cry of fright, a splash and the mother saw her boy in the water. The air under his blouse was holding him up, while with one hand he reached out in appeal to his mother for help, and the other holding aloft his treasured whistle.

The descent from the sidewalk to the water along this bank is several feet and almost perpendicular—in places the walk overhangs the river. The mother was powerless to aid, as were four mill workers who were near the spot. One of the men present said it would have been sheer suicide for any man to have attempted to swim in this water, as it was ice cold from the melted snow of the mountains and the current fast and strong. There was no rope, no boat, and before any help could be found the boy floated against the Hawley paper mill and sank.

The mother fainted and was taken aboard a car and taken home.

How the boy fell into the water is not made clear. There is a railing along the car tracks on the river side about four feet high, but there is a space between the sidewalk and the boards on this railing of something over two feet. It is thought the boy slipped on the wet boards and fell through this aperture.

The boy's father was a former employee of the woolen mills, but left for Providence, R. I., about three weeks ago, where he has secured a position, and where his wife and son soon expected to follow. He was not

ified by wire of his boy's death and started at once for this city. After searching and watching for the body all day Sunday, Hugh Brady, a Portland diver, was secured Monday, but he was unable to find the body. He said he did not think the body floated far, and did not go over the falls, but the water is very deep in the basin and it was almost impossible to make a thorough search. The mother has been in a serious condition, bordering on nervous collapse.

CASE OF WAIT AND HOPE.

Oregon City will Get Terminal if Any City Does.

A railroad official who is out of his job, and who hopes to stay on, is as non-committal as a congressman during a campaign, and when General Freight Lounsbury of the Southern Pacific, smiled, talked and argued over the matter of terminal rates for this city, yet refused to commit himself, the committee was not at all disappointed or disheartened.

The committee to confer with Mr. Lounsbury was B. T. McBain, Edward Schwab, W. A. Huntley, L. Adams, E. E. Brodie, E. E. Price, M. J. Brown, and following a dinner at The Falls, the committee went to the Commercial Club rooms, where the matter of terminal rates was discussed for over two hours.

Whether Oregon City will get terminal rates or not remains to be determined, but it will be no fault of Chairman McBain if we do not. This man has made an exhaustive study of railroading and railroad rates and what he didn't know about the subject, the Southern Pacific official did not.

Mr. Lounsbury went over the matter thoroughly with the committee, talked frankly with them about the railroads' position from his point of view, and advised that Oregon City wait until the U. S. supreme court handed down its decision in the long and short haul case, as nothing could be done until this decision was reached.

In connection with rates between here and Portland, it is rumored that the Willamette Paper & Pulp Co. is planning the formation of a river transportation company and the building of one or two new boats.

"Let the Women do the Work."

The Courier believes the publicity department of the Live Wires got in wrong when it tried to make a hen park, or tennis park, of the city park.

When a bunch of men try to handle such matters they are much like the fellow who broke into a Kings' Daughters' sewing bee by mistake. The city park is about as awful as it could be made to make it. Vacant lots shine by comparison. Now if the city will only turn it over where it belongs, and let the Woman's Club manage it, they won't know the place in three months.

The chicken show is Friday and Saturday.

## THREE MINUTE BUSINESS TALKS.

Matters the Live Wires are Connecting With.

SUBJECTS DISCUSSED TUESDAY

Many Matters for City and County Good Under Way.

When a man has considerable to say and only three little minutes to say it in, he isn't going to drag in any flowery or try for high oratory. He just gets right onto the talk doings and works like a barber on piece work.

And this is one reason why the Live Wires luncheons are never tedious and ever interesting.

Tuesday there was a lot of live talk and considerable sense condensed into thirty minutes. President McBain reported on the terminal rate conference with the Southern Pacific officials, and he stated that when the case before the supreme court was decided, then if any city in Oregon was granted this concession, this city would be in as good shape as any.

A report of the canneries committee was made and the matter is not dead by any means. A. D. Lee of Portland is taking the matter up with eastern capitalists, who are interested in this field, and the matter is being looked up there.

O. D. Eby made a short talk on the coming chicken show and he said there would be 400 birds entered, besides geese, cats, dogs, turkeys, etc. He said the project had met with unexpected success; that Portland's recent show had 1200 entries and the promoters boasted it was the greatest exhibition ever held west of the Rocky mountains while Oregon City, with but a fraction of Portland's population, had a fourth as many entries.

The committee on the matter of a public sport ground will meet at Sept. Gary's office Monday next. Asked to say a few words about the Clackamas Southern railroad, Judge Dimick said the company did not owe a dollar, that a deal is under way for the purchase of \$50,000 of these rails which will lay the track complete to Molalla; that 10.26 miles are graded and ready for ties; that the ties have been bought and with the coming of spring work would resume. Mr. Dimick related that he had copies of letters written to prospective bond buyers, with intent to knock and injure the sale of bonds, and he deplored such acts by those who had loyalty to state, county or city. But he further stated \$30,000 of the bonds had been sold, and deal was under way to sell the rest of the issue to a English bond firm.

Mr. Dimick took the chicken show for a text to show how badly this great industry was neglected in Oregon. He said five cars of eggs were

shipped into Portland in one day recently; that our winterless climate was especially adapted to hen raising, that we should and could raise eggs to export to other states, but as a matter of fact Oregon alone had to bring in eggs from Canada, Woodburn and other towns.

M. D. Latourrette reported that Oregon City with other towns would go to Portland Friday night and ask the P. R. L. & P. Co. for lower passenger rates, but rates now high are given in another column.

Postmaster Randal reported the matter of a federal building was being kept alive in Washington, but on account of the action of congress in cutting out the public buildings appropriation, there was a small likelihood of getting the appropriation this year.

Superintendent Tooe reported that the matter of an examination of our milk supplies had been brought to the state board of health for action.

M. J. Brown said he had had a talk with Westerfield, who lives 3 1/2 miles out on route No. 6. Mr. Westerfield is familiar with every town and city in the Willamette valley. He said he had seen many local canneries start and fail; that the Medford factory was a failure and the investors would be glad to get their money out. On the other hand he stated he had yet to see or know of a creamery failure; that such an industry would be of the utmost benefit to farmers; that dairy butter was discriminated against by retailers and consumers, and he finally stated that he would be the first man to put \$100 into starting a creamery here.

President McBain appointed a committee to confer with Mr. Westerfield and get his ideas as to the best means to bring the matter to a practical end. The club voted to have one meeting each month in the evening, when more time could be given to public projects.

## THE COURIER IS YOURS.

Its Columns are Open to Any Person on Any Subject.

The Courier is pleased to see the people use its columns on the many different issues and subjects that have us guessing these days, and again we extend to any man or woman the use of these columns—to take sides on any issue with anything the editor may see fit to bring forward any idea the writer may have; to discuss any public matter from any viewpoint.

The Courier isn't a personal organ, printed to air its editor's opinions and keep other editors' opinions.

You can't stay long for any man or woman who has something to say and can say it decently. You may favor license, or liquor prohibition; you may be for or against woman's suffrage; you may be Republican, Democrat, Socialist, Prolet, We invite you to come in.

The Courier editor has always contended that the people who subscribe for his paper are by virtue of that subscription entitled to the use of its columns. A one-man newspaper isn't a public medium, and I hold that every man who reads it has a right to come back on any opinion that it prints.

Discussion broadens men and women. Two sides bring out new ideas. Argument educates and breeds thinking.

You may use these columns on any matter that's decent. If we don't agree with you, we will come back at you. The same privilege is yours. And out of the friendly differences we'll all be developing some unused brain cells.

And if you can't put a comma just where it should be, and should happen to misspell a word or two—don't hesitate. We're here to dot your "i's" and cross your "t's."

## REGISTRATION IS FALSE.

W. W. Myers Gives Voters Some Figures to Think Over.

Editor Courier: According to promise we are here with the goods. We will now proceed to show the registration of two years ago, also the vote at the general election. I am unable to get the exact figures as to the registration, but we find from investigation that the registration shows over 75 per cent Republicans and about 55 per cent in the general election, also of about 20 per cent of registrations. Or in other words take the total vote for secretary of state. It stands, Republican 3050, Democratic 1598, Socialist 802, Prohibition, 393, total 5843. I think the total registration was about 5000. Out of this the combined registration other than Republicans was about 1300. Assuming that the votes sworn in as Republicans polled only 2084, and the total of all were only 3366 and 5499, leaving quite a few refusing to vote for either. This I claim shows a false registration. Whose fault is it Mr. Mulvey? These figures show about 1300 voters disfranchised in the primary, who at the same time are paying their share of taxes to support the law—taxation without representation. Also the law destroys the secrecy in way of the Australian ballot. The county records are subject to all the politicians and corporations as well as the state records. We speak advisedly when we say we know what this means to the wage earner. The hand of the corporation lawyer is shown in all the so-called labor laws and the politicians are not going to be fooled much longer. Some fine day they will rise in their power and throw off the yoke and some of us that are not wage slaves are going to lend a helping hand. Say, it is up to some of you wise guys to amend the laws so as to give the laboring man a fair, square, Democratic deal. Just cast your eagle eye over to Germany and you can guess what's going to happen here soon.

Yours, W. W. MYERS.

The little class ads on page eight do the business.

## OVER THE FALLS TO HIS DEATH.

Engine Dies and Boat is Left Helpless.

JOSEPH BENART MEETS DEATH

Tragic Ending of Life of Old, Well Known Riverman.

The old Willamette is taking heavy toll of human life this spring, its waters having swallowed up two persons within a week.

That was an uneven outcome to a gallant fight for life, when Joseph Benart went over the falls to his death Wednesday night, just at sunset.

His gasoline engine refused to work, every minute the rushing river carried him nearer, and at last it carried him over. And history has it that but one man has ever gone over the falls and lived.

Benart was an old river man, and none knew the river and its dangers better than he. For forty years he had towed logs for the mills and the stream was almost his home.

Wednesday he came down the river in his launch from his farm near New Era and tied his launch in the basin near Hawley's mill. At night he started for home, but his engine gave trouble, and people going home from the mills remarked that he was in a dangerous place for engine trouble.

But the engine soon started and he steered the boat for the upstream side. When near the concrete pier, by Mill A of the Hawley mills, the engine went dead, and the boat drifted toward the falls. Vainly trying to start it, Benart grabbed an oar and worked desperately to get out of the current.

It was useless and he went over the falls.

A lady witness said to the Courier that when the old man realized it was hopeless, he turned his back to the falls, braced himself with a hold on each side of the boat and took the fall. The boat was found under the suspension bridge, with both sides smashed, and is now tied up behind Busch's store.

The body has not been recovered and probably will not be for some weeks.

## HERE'S THE STARTER.

Big Main Street Block will Open City's Boom Year.

Last week the Courier mentioned a big Main street business deal under way. It has gone through and been tied up.

The Mt. Hood Brewing Co. has taken a long lease of the Ross property on the corner of Main and Eighth streets, embracing 66 feet and back 170 feet, embracing the corner saloon, Straight & Salisbury's plumbing store, and J. F. Westenberg's harness shop.

And on this property will be erected a handsome business block, two stories, modern front, and a big hall, have a saloon, a store and an up-to-date moving picture theatre. George Simmons has already leased the picture theatre for a long term.

The tenants of the present building have been ordered out and work will be commenced on the new building at once. The block will add much to the present rather unsightly section of Main street.

## A MATTER TO GO SLOW ON.

There are Some Boycott Plans That Bound Back.

It is reported to this office that the dealers in the line of goods in this city have got together and entered into a "gentlemen's agreement" not to advertise in Oregon City papers.

We hope this story isn't true, but there is a lot of circumstantial evidence that goes with it.

An advertiser who may advertise nor not—that's his right and his business. But a combination agreeing not to advertise isn't legal or moral right—and it's OUR business.

When the newspapers of Oregon City were threatened with being boycotted to the city, stay with it 33 weeks in the year, booming the city and working for more business, and then have a portion of those benefited of forming a boycott against them—

Well, we live this to say—It is just as good as the newspapers may hit back—and hit hard.

And again it is just possible that the reading and buying public MIGHT take the newspapers' side of the matter, and agree not to buy of these places. Better think this over again.

## CARNEGIE BUILDING SOON.

Slightly Location at Head of Seventh Street Stairway Chosen.

If the city council will give to the library association the city lot at the head of the Seventh street stairway, Oregon City will speedily commence the erection of a \$12,500 Carnegie library. A petition asking the city council for this action was presented Wednesday night.

The site asked for is the V shaped lot between the Southern Pacific tracks, the Singer Hill highway and the Seventh street stairway, and it is proposed to erect the building on cement walls to the level of the street and also have entrances from the stairways.

A handsome public building on this slightly point would do away with the present very unsightly ravine and it would add greatly to the appearance of the bluff and the stairways. But far above appearances would this public library benefit Oregon City. One has

but to see the hundreds of patrons go in and out of the present library each week to realize the need of a greater library. And as one of our citizens recently remarked, it will not be a ways that such buildings will be given away—Mr. Carnegie is becoming an old man.

It is held that if the city will donate his site that the work on same will be commenced at once, and it is further stated that it will not be necessary to increase the tax rate a half mill, as the increased valuation of property and the assessment thereon will bring this added revenue.

The sentiment, so far as this paper can determine, is almost unanimously in favor of accepting Mr. Carnegie's offer, and the general view is that the city will cheerfully do its part in the gift of the site.

## THE OLD, OLD STORY.

After the Horse is Stolen, we Put a Lock on the Barn.

Today public sentiment runs high that conditions should not be permitted whereby a child should lose his life by so trivial a means as accidental stumbling or slipping on a public highway, and the people are demanding that such conditions be at once completely remedied.

And what an awful price it has taken to make this demand—the price of a human life, the price of happy little boy.

It is now said the railing along the Canemah sidewalk has long been considered as unsafe for children, as is also the railing along the suspension bridge.

But it has taken a human life to stir us to action.

Now, aroused to the great danger, and having paid the penalty of neglect, let us safeguard the future, and protect other children.

There should be no place on any public thoroughfare where it is even possible for a child to lose its life. It is our duty to make these places absolutely safe, and we hope and believe the county court will aid public demand in forever making absolutely safe the walk where little Paul Platt lost his life, and any other places of like danger.

And among the safeguards should be protection on top of the bluff, where conditions are even more dangerous than along the river. And don't let us wait until a boy or girl is killed before we take precautions.

## A Little Late, But—

We learn from an authoritative source that the grand jury, considerably behind time, will meet here February 12.

## COMMENDS COURIER'S STAND.

Readers Want Paper that Will Stand for Square Deal.

Cherryville, Jan. 28. Mr. Editor: I noticed in a recent issue of your valuable paper that you have hoisted the Democratic colors to the wind. That's right, show your colors! Some of the ablest and best men in the country are in the Democratic ranks. A party that can boast of such men as that splendid scholar and statesman, Woodrow Wilson, one of the foremost men of the age; Champ Clark, one of the most brilliant and profound statesmen of this great land; or that great and shining citizen W. J. Bryan, the greatest living orator of this or any other country and a true friend of the great masses of the common people, nobody need be ashamed of.

It is true a person ought not to be so hide-bound as to vote for anybody on the ticket regardless of ability or fitness for the place. In fact, the people of Oregon, both Republicans and Democrats, exercise their privilege of voting for men on either ticket as they prefer, which is right. The writer would rather vote for La Follette on the Republican ticket than Harmon on the Democratic ticket, and so would many others with whom we have talked.

Your open and plain speaking editorials are all right. The people are tired of flim-flammers who are continually deceiving them with false promises and hypocritical pretensions, and we are looking for somebody whom we can depend upon.

We are descended from a noble line of progenitors who counted not their lives nor fortunes in defense of their country and the sacred cause of human liberty. Are we then the degenerate sons of those illustrious sires who dared all things and did all things to build a good foundation for a great country, dedicated for all time for humanity and liberty?

More power to your elbow, Brother Brown, and may you continue to slay-wing the robber trusts and tariff hogs and all blood-sucking monopolies which are grinding the face of the poor.

PARNELL AVERILL.

## What's the Reason?

In two months the HUB GROCERY CO.'S business has nearly doubled. Every week we get new customers and we hold the old ones.

There are reasons for this growing business and here they are: Every article is what we represent it, to our best knowledge.

The customer is given down weight on every article that goes onto the scales.

We cheerfully make anything right that is not right.

And we sell every article at the price it should be sold at.

We would be glad to send you a trial order. **Hub Phones 4-1**

The Hub Grocery Company

Cor. 7th and Center Sts.

## THE HOME OF GREAT SILENCE.

A Pen Picture of America's Great Desert.

THE LAND OF AWFUL THIRST.

Our Country's Sahara as Seen by the Courier Editor.

If you want to realize what this country's great out of doors is, get out in this country's Great American desert, way out in the fearful heat waste, watch the train pull out and leave you, and then sit down and let the awfulness of the solitude and desolation soak in.

One cannot conceive of the heart sickness, home sickness and awful loneliness of this desolate waste until he has become a part of it. Great ravens sail overhead, hairy tarantulas bask in the awful heat, the deadly rattler and the lizards crawl over the hot sands. Solitude and heat—desolation. And what a desert. It commences up in Idaho and continues to the Gulf of California, and parts of Idaho, Wyoming, Utah, Nevada and California are in its grasp. Its most gruesome and deadly corner is Death Valley, in California.

I had intended to visit this spot but stopped off in Arizona, and I saw enough desert there to last me for one trip.

We have an impression that a desert is one great stretch of level sand, where not a sign of vegetation ever grows, but this impression is very far from the real conditions. The American desert is full of great valleys, mountain ranges, sandy wastes, extinct volcanoes, lava flows, cacti, sunshiners, heat and desolation.

I picked out a spot that looked lonesome and far away on the map—well out in Arizona—and I found it was all that the map portrayed it. I learned that the west bound train stopped there to let the limited by and that at night a local stopped—I don't know why, unless for the accommodation of fellows as foolish as myself.

The town marked on the map as a station was simply a section place, where a little white man kept a dozen greasers and a handcar.

The trains passed and vanished, and there I stood, in the Great American Desert, with nothing but moving things visible. I thought I would stay over night at a section house and have nearly two full days to see the big waste, but before that train was out of sight it was six for me, and could I have by any means reached it, someone else could have had my desert description job.

The section gang was off somewhere trying to figure some scheme to make the ties keep their places in dry sand, and reduce railroad wrecks, and I was all there was of China. I was the consul.

Marking the place where the section house was by a big bluff near it, I struck out on foot to "do the desert," and remembering the many tales I had heard of the strange fascinations of this land of thirst, and how the strange-colored ranges and the glittering sands lead one on, I kept the low gear working and my eye on the bluff near the depot—that one mark of something close to the living.

Fifty years ago this desert was better known than today when the lure of California lured thousands of men, arid wastes with human bones. Today we ride through on a limited, fret at the heat and dust, look out the windows at the bunches of cacti and go home and say we have been in the Great American desert.

But in those days no streaks of steel crossed this awful waste, and while I sat there hour after hour waiting for the section men to return, I blotted the Santa Fe off the map and went back to '49.

And what a picture my imagination produced. A picture of pariahs plodding across this burning waste, of men with fear in their hearts and trust in their veins; of plodding oxen and mules dragging across this desolation with protruding tongues and blistering and cracked hoofs; of the desert buzzards in lazy pursuit, waiting for someone to die; of the drawn faces of the women and the thirst delirium of the children—and then the end, and the ghastly human bones that waited there today.

It seems to me that the penal places of other countries would be pleasant resorts compared with America's Sahara. I could picture the mines of Siberia, the Yucatan rubber forests, and the desert of Australia as Coney Island laid side by side with this spot of America.

If a man-proof fence were run around the thousands of acres of this Arizona and the criminals of our country dumped into it, hell would quit business in thirty days because it could not meet competition.

I had not my watch, and I had nothing by which to judge time, for strange to relate, the sky was not covered with clouds—an unusual sight in the desert. I dared not get out of sight of the railroad and could not tell when the train would come, and when I looked down the track to the west and saw a dot that I knew was a hand car, well, I knew something of how those caravans must have felt when they found an oasis.

The section boss was a grizzled white man who had served fifty years in teaching the Mexicans to drive spikes, and after I had coaxed him a little on the English language, he recalled that he was once a white man, and he told me many interesting things about the desert.

There is a weird fascination in this arid waste that almost any visitor will admit and none can explain. There is a something that entices, that calls to you to come on. No matter how cautious a man, he wants to go just a little farther, just over the next draw. He doesn't know what he is looking for, but he expects something—something lure him on, beckons to him.

The section man told me that some of his own Mexicans, men reared to

(Continued on Page 2.)

## WHY ALL Progressive Merchants ARE USING Electric Light



Progressive merchants everywhere have found the wonderful MAZDA LAMP an immeasurable benefit to their business. This lamp radiates brilliant white rays nearly like those of the sun. This SUPERIOR QUALITY of artificial light is produced by a rare metal filament that not only radiates a perfect light, but gives nearly THREE TIMES as much light as the ordinary incandescent—and COSTS NO MORE to burn. It is this remarkable combination of facts that is causing thousands of people to have their houses and places of business wired for electric light. In fact, this new MAZDA LAMP is swiftly revolutionizing artificial lighting. It is making electricity the universal illuminant.

## Portland Railway, Light & Power Company

ELECTRIC STORE SEVENTH & ALDER

PORTLAND